

Wolverine

Gulo gulo

Known as the glutton, albeit unfairly, the wolverine satisfies its voracious appetite by killing prey as big as deer. Its strong jaws rip open the toughest hides and crush the biggest bones in search of marrow. Although it is in fact a huge weasel, its heavy fur, sturdy legs, and large feet give the wolverine a bearlike appearance. It can walk on snow with its broad feet, and survive extreme conditions in remote forests, tundra, and mountains encircling the Arctic.

Wolverines store food after a big kill. Reindeer and caribou are dismembered and buried in snow or soil, or pushed into rock crevices and gullies. They mate in summer and two to four cubs are born the following spring.

↔ 26–41 in (65–105 cm)

⚖ 13–40 lb (6–18 kg)

⊗ Common

🍖 Deer, hare, birds, fruit



NW. to N. North America,
NE. Europe to N. and E. Asia

▽ ON THE GO

Short, powerful legs and a supple, shuffling action help the wolverine cover long distances at a relentless pace in search of food, with minimum expenditure of energy.



◁ PALMATE ANTLETS

Male moose grow a new set of their massive antlers every summer. These have a covering of soft skin, or “velvet,” which is shed by autumn, the mating season.

▽ LOSING BATTLE

This female moose managed to defend her week-old calf from a pack of wolves for 10 minutes, but, despite her superior size and power, they were able to drag the calf away from her.

